PROPOSAL TO THE BOARD OF EDUCATION

Student Safety & Trust Framework

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As students, we know schools work within legal, personnel, and privacy limits. Still, several incidents across elementary, middle, and high schools have left many students uncertain and worried. When serious things happen and little is said beyond short statements, it is hard to know how safety systems are working or how future harm is prevented.

The Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction calls for safe, supportive, inclusive schools and continuous improvement through reflection, transparency, and listening to stakeholders. For students, safety means physical protection, but also trust in reporting systems, confidence that adults are accountable, and clarity about how concerns are handled.

Six proposals

1. **Clear acknowledgment when serious incidents happen.** Even when details can't be shared, communication that acknowledges the impact, explains the general process, and restates safeguards reduces rumors and anxiety.
2. **A district-wide safety and reporting overview.** A clear explanation of how concerns are reported, investigated, and resolved, including the roles of school leaders, district leaders, and outside authorities.
3. **Consistent safety and conduct rules across all schools.** Students notice when similar situations are handled differently between buildings. One district-wide approach, aligned with restorative practices, supports fairness.
4. **Stronger student voice on school climate and safety.** Ongoing student advisory groups at the middle and high school levels, with required responses from administrators.
5. **Proactive mental health and wellness support.** Regular advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, and clear ways to get help before problems grow.
6. **Ongoing review.** Regular climate surveys, public summaries of results, and open discussion of what is improving.

Why this matters

These ideas are not about blame. They are about systems that help students feel safe, supported, and confident in the adults and structures meant to protect them. SPASD can build trust by looking beyond single incidents to the broader systems that shape students' experiences.

Independent and student-led. Written by Zackary Mark, a high school student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. Not an official SPASD document and does not speak for the district, its staff, or its Board. Shared in good faith; not meant to accuse any person. Contact: zackarymark160@gmail.com · Instagram @spasdstudentvoice